

2.2 Strategy

Strategy games place the spotlight on the player's thinking and decision-making abilities. That's why some people call strategy games "the thinking man's game". All actions that the player takes have a major impact on the outcome of the game, as opposed to, say, FPSes, where the player simply does what he is told to do by the game. The strategy genre can be further sub-divided into:

- (A) **Puzzle:** Puzzle games involve solving puzzles, which could involve, logic, pattern recognition, and strategy. These games are extremely popular because of their simplicity and ease of use. *Tetris*, *Minesweeper* and *Solitaire* are examples of puzzle games.
- (B) **RPG:** RPG stands for Role-Playing Game. They generally involve long, intricate plots with an emphasis on character development. As the game progresses, the characters gain various abilities and can achieve feats. The gamer has to choose which feats to acquire so as to complete the game. Today a number of games incorporate RPG elements, but can be distinguished from proper RPGs by the unique gameplay of the latter. *EverQuest*, *Star Wars: Knights Of The Old Republic*, *Baldur's Gate*, *Runescape* and *Neverwinter Nights* are just some of the more well-known RPGs.

A lot of RPGs involve a storyline that is driven forward by player responses. The direction the game takes thus depends completely on the gamer himself. *Star Wars: Knights Of The Old Republic*



A typical puzzle game would look similar to the above